

**SPECIAL SCHOOL COMMITTEE MEETING NOTES -**  
**Thursday, August 6, 2020 - 6:00 PM - Via Zoom**

**Mayor - called meeting to order at 6:05 PM**

**Roll Call & Salute to the Flag - 7-0**

**Motion by Member Ruseau to enter executive session, seconded by Member Graham**

**Roll Call Vote - 7-0 - motion to enter executive session at 6:09 PM carries**

**Mayor - thank you all for your patience. Ms. Douglas would like to make a statement.**

**Ms. Douglas' Statement on behalf of the Medford Teachers Association:**

Esteemed Mayor, Members of the Medford School Committee, Members of the Medford City Council, and Superintendent of Schools Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent;

Safety. The driving force behind all the work that the task forces, the community, the students and the elected officials have done has been the safety of students, teachers, administrators and families as COVID-19 tears through communities across the state and country. We appreciate that thoughtful conversations have taken place about health and safety and the various learning plans that Commissioner Riley has asked all superintendents to submit to DESE. However, there are fundamental questions and concerns that still need to be addressed.

Like our colleagues across the state, Medford educators want nothing more than to return to their classrooms to be with their students and provide them the best possible education. However, that same concern for our students' well-being and education that is pushing us to return to our physical buildings is also pulling us to stay home, for them and for each other — at least for a while longer. As much as it pains us to say it, current scientific data and public health guidelines tell us that it is not possible to return without hurting our community. It does not make sense to return to schools when we do not fully understand the risks that the virus poses to children and adults, when standards and plans for facilities are not well established, when all proper safety

procedures and staffing are not in place, when we do not have rapid testing and robust contact tracing, and while COVID-19 rates are increasing in Massachusetts.

While we recognize that in-person learning is the best model, public safety has always been the first priority. Because of the danger of fire, we interrupt education to practice facing that danger as we perform fire drills throughout the year. Because of the danger of school shootings, we interrupt education to practice facing that danger when we perform lockdown drills. We even cancel education when the weather poses a safety threat. COVID is an ever-present threat to the safety of our community. It is more dangerous and less predictable than weather. It is hidden. It is aggressive. It is highly contagious. And it kills.

When we reopen schools, the question will be not *whether* COVID will spread through our schools, but *when*. The question won't be *whether* we can contain the spread, but *how many* people will be infected before we get back the test results confirming our first cases. The question won't be *whether* someone will die, but *why* we approved of such an unsafe path to begin with.

While six-foot distancing and masks are the accepted safety standard, other elements such as sufficient flow of clean air and unshared desk spaces are not feasible in our schools. Additionally, indoor mask breaks for any reason, including meals or individual health concerns, negate the safety provided by masks. The virus does not take a mask break. The virus does not pause while we have lunch. In fact, COVID-19 has proven especially adept at transmitting itself during meals, when people fill the air with saliva and aerosol molecules that linger in an enclosed environment. The virus will certainly not take a timeout when students are jammed in stairwells and hallways for legally mandated fire drills, where they will have no choice but to be in close contact with each other in enclosed spaces for an extended time. The virus will certainly not take a timeout when students are only three feet apart on our buses, and not at all distanced on MBTA buses. To prepare ourselves against fire danger, we will subject everyone to very real COVID danger.

Humans are unpredictable, and children are doubly so. No amount of planning can prepare us for the unexpected eventualities that *will* occur. In the heat of September, frustrated students *will* remove their masks. Students feeling socially isolated *will* arrange to meet in bathrooms and corridors. Elementary students *will* want to hug their educators or get close to them and each other. By putting the entire population, or even 50 percent of the population, in the buildings at once we magnify the variables exponentially. For the mathematicians, this is chaos theory. For the literary, this is, "The best laid schemes of mice and men often go awry." The stakes are quite literally life and death.

The more we understand about the virus, the clearer the dangers of in-person reopening become. Regardless of my own feelings and educators' deep desire to return in-person teaching, I have to make data-driven decisions. I side with science and the recent studies released by JAMA and the CDC about COVID-19 in children. And I hope this School Committee does the same.

As I said, educators are deeply committed to returning to in-person learning, but Only When It's Safe. In order for us to reopen safely, we need to commit BOTH to a deliberate phased-in approach that gradually increases the number of people in our buildings over time AND a promise to make critical infrastructure improvements. A great deal of updating is needed to ensure that all who enter our buildings are adequately protected by improved air flow and filtration, in addition to PPE and social distancing. We also need effective, established protocols for the inevitable moment when a student or staff member shows symptoms of or is diagnosed with coronavirus.

Last week, the Medford Teachers Association asked our members, "What are your current concerns about returning to in-person teaching?" Eighty-eight percent of the teachers surveyed had concerns with the sanitation and ventilation of the school buildings. Then on Wednesday, August 5, we asked our members about their level of comfort in starting the school year based on the information available now. Within 24 hours, 81 percent responded, and 91 percent said it's best to start the year remotely, with the intent of phasing in hybrid instruction options when safety benchmarks are met.

I should note that it is not lost on anyone that while the School Committee considers not just one but three plans that call for large numbers of staff and students to be in our school buildings in just over three weeks' time, this body continues to meet remotely. If six feet of distance is acceptable for our students and educators for six hours a day with masks on, why aren't you willing to sit six feet apart from one another on the dais of the City Hall Chamber, where you traditionally meet? The answer is obvious. Because it isn't safe. Not yet.

When you are ready, I suggest you follow a model similar to what we are proposing, one that has been used to reopen businesses and restaurants safely and successfully here in Medford: gradually phasing in in-person public participation, with opportunities to pre register and wait in a socially distant line to speak during public comment. Maybe residents can even sit in designated, physically distanced seats in the audience. Surely I'm not the first to suggest moving public meetings to the Chevalier Theatre, just down the street from your regular meeting space, where the public could actually watch in person and remain six feet apart. If I am, I don't need to take credit for it. Once you can do that, maybe then we can seriously discuss how to return staff and students to the school buildings.

Once we reopen our schools, we want to keep them open. Rushing this process and putting too many people back in the buildings too soon will very likely cause the infection rate to spike and trigger another shutdown. This would only disrupt the learning process even further and exacerbate the well-known inequities that existed in our schools before — and continue to exist during the pandemic. Rushing this process will endanger the lives of our entire community.

We would be much wiser to begin — safely and remotely — than to put students', educators' and parents' lives at risk. Once we feel sure we can provide the safest situation possible in our schools, we can slowly bring back those students who need in-person education the most. Once we experience success with a small in-person population, we might consider adding more groups — again, the ones with the greatest need, and then our youngest children. The magnification of variables once we reach middle and high school makes in-person education at those grades the last phase. We want to develop close connections with our students and build classroom community. We want to prioritize their well-being, their social emotional development, and their learning. The first steps can be to meet with students outdoors during the beginning of the school year in cohorts, so that they can meet their teachers and classmates and establish that rapport. Instead of looking at how to teach in a very complicated and most likely short-lived hybrid model, let us focus on developing a robust and effective remote-learning model, ensuring that our students and families have the proper equipment and that our educators can rework the curriculum and learn the best methods.

I also implore you to think about these scenarios as you make your decision tonight. If a teacher dies, the emotional devastation to a student (especially a student who feels he or she might have transmitted the virus to the teacher) will be irreparable. If a grandparent or a parent dies because we made the dangerous choice, the stupid choice, the magnitude of the loss will make the loss of a unit of instruction seem insignificant by comparison. If a child dies, we will all have to live with the guilt.

We have the chance to make the right choice, the safe choice. We should make that choice now, not after the damage has been done and we find ourselves attending the funerals of our families, friends and children.

We do not want to see yearbooks at the end of this school year with pages of “In Memoriam” dedicated to the educators and students we could lose to COVID-19 if we return to the buildings too quickly. We don't want to reflect back on this process and be complicit in rushing Medford educators and students back into an unsafe environment. I'll also never be the type of leader who tells my union siblings what is best for them, overruling the democratic wishes of our rank-and-file organization. This decision isn't mine to make in a vacuum any more than it is the committee's or the superintendent's. At this time, it is the opinion of the Medford Teachers Association that the only way to safely reopen schools — and keep them open — is to start

remotely and gradually work our way to a full reopening based on the conditions in our schools, scientific data and public health benchmarks. Anything else would be reckless, irresponsible and counterproductive.

I thank you for your time, and I look forward to continuing these discussions.

Respectfully submitted, Charlene Douglas, President, Medford Teachers Association

**Mayor - Thank you Charlene. Next up, the adjusted school calendar**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - DESE reduced days from 180 days to 170 days -  
August 31st - PD Day**

**September 1st - was originally supposed to be first day for students**

**New start date - Wednesday/September 16th**

**Proposing Wednesday/January 20 - 21st - as additional PD day**

**Member Ruseau - Motion to approve, seconded by Member Graham**

**Roll Call - 7-0 - adjusted school calendar has been approved**

**Mayor - Madam Superintendent's Presentation of the Reopening Plan**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent- I will be sharing our Powerpoint with everyone of our  
Dynamic Return Plan**

**Mayor - While we are waiting for the powerpoint, I would like to take this  
opportunity to thank all the parents/teachers/administrators. So many people  
worked countless hours on this plan. I realize not everyone will be happy. I  
know that everyone's struggling and this decision will be hard. Please know  
that we all have all of the children/staff best interests at heart.**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Here is the Return to School framework. Our  
presentation objectives: background of plan, share overview of 3 models we  
were tasked with from DESE, and share schedule for potential of phased-in**

**reopening. The school committee will vote on a plan this evening. Our aspirations are to prioritize safely returning students to in person learning through strict health and safety requirements, as well as, ensure remote learning is robust.**

**In late June - A survey was presented to families - these are the percentages of parents who wanted their children to go back to in person learning:**

**92% - MHS**

**89% - Middle**

**92% - Elementary**

**Overall - 91% wanted in person classes**

**Our Core Values Are: Safety, consistency and equity**

**Mr. Milaschewski - Our 5 Key challenges:**

- 1. Public Health Challenge**
- 2. Lack of Agreement**
- 3. Lack of precedence**
- 4. Lack of Time**
- 5. Decisions will be scrutinized**

**With shifting circumstances - we hope to present options with no good options.**

**These are obvious, but these challenges have led to divisions**

**Models:**

**In person**

**Hybrid Learning**

**Remote Learning**

**School committee will select an option tonight**

**The Superintendent wanted the task force to be inclusive, collaborative, racially diverse and community based - Steering Committee, Operations workgroup, Instruction workgroup, (in person/hybrid and remote), Community and Stakeholders Engagement Workgroup, and building based teams.**

**Dr. Cushing - I will go over the timeline which began the week of July 6th - The draft was released July 31st, and had well over 3500 clicks to look at the document. The final draft is being worked on as we speak. We were able to discuss it with the community via Facebook ...on Monday, there were over 400 who participated and on Tuesday, there were over 300 who participated.**

**The Options:**

**Full in person is not recommended at this time**

**Remote is available for all students, regardless of model that is chosen**

**Building feasibility - is a big concern - we couldn't maintain 6ft distance as recommended by CDC, parents & teachers/staff - just not viable at this time**

**Ms. Galusi - Hybrid + Remote - in school days and at home learning days - group looked at 12 options and narrowed down to our option - some high needs will be in person if parent chooses.**

**Medford Hybrid Model Chart - Wednesdays are half days - Sample hybrid models - elementary, middle & high school / voke schedule would be slightly different. These are all a draft only! Specials are included: art, computer, phys ed - Music has to be online learning. WIN Block = what an individual needs - specific student needs provided during this block. High need students will participate in full in person instruction with effective accommodations. (Instruction Mon, Tue, Thur & Fri) We are awaiting DESE guidance for EL students**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - we are looking towards a phased reopening:**

**Phase 1 - staff only - student/family orientations - meet teachers/peers**

**Phase 2 - September 16th - K and 1st grade - start school by seeing their teacher in person - small groups. Curtis-Tufts students will be in person, Monday, Tuesday, Thursday & Friday. Grade 6th - would start on the 1st day of school - 85 students at a time - for 1 month.**

**October 13th - 7th and 8th phased in**

**High School - starts last due to ventilation system issues - Oct 26th for 9th graders - Nov 9th - 10th, 11th & 12th will be phased in.**

**Vocational - specialized programming - 11th and 12th graders need practical experience - Grade 12th - would begin on Sept 28th - 55 students at a time on the vocational side of the house - Oct 13th - 11th grade would be phased in - with an additional 70 students.**

**The goal is to combine in person and remote and managing numbers at the schools at the same time**

**Dr. Cushing - we recognize safety concerns for ventilation at Medford High School. We have contractors coming in Monday, looking at screens at all buildings - other buildings HVAC will be looked at as well - to advance as much filtration as possible - and we will update everyone - Principal Fallon has already stated that working in the Vocational bays, to keep the air flowing - also might include outdoor classes as well - it is all being considered - we hear you - a work in progress with our goal to keep everyone safe. Remote - will mirror a typical school day, and adhere to the district's curriculum - we want you to remain with the Medford Public Schools, rather than the homeschool option.**

**Ms. Galusi - For the fully remote model - students would be learning at home - high needs students can option this as well - with a structured schedule for all DESE wants (Live) synchronous teaching and communication both ways Remote Academy - live and recorded instruction - teachers will use google classroom - there will be the possibility of using a breakout room as well - the Clever System will be used for all educational platforms and applications**

**All of these schedules are drafts, just to give you an example of a schedule for a fully remote remodel. Alternating screen time added in, so students are not online all day - flexibility here - specials will be available remotely too - provides for families to have same schedules**

**Hybrid + Remote**

**Pros - flexibility to adapt, live instruction, 6 ft spacing & positive social emotional learning.**

**Cons - increased health risks, scheduling cohorts of students for learning & associated activities & scheduling challenges for working families.**

**Remote Model**

**Cons - reliable and consistent internet, social emotional learning impact from lack of in person instruction (welfare of our children suffers), increase need for parental support & students may struggle to learn online**

**Pros - safest model from medical/scientific perspective, Potential for students to learn on their own time & having a known schedule.**

**Member Ruseau - Thank you for the incredible amount of work included in this plan - no way to thank everyone for the amount of time needed to put this into place - there is no good plan - but we have to pick one**

**Member Graham - Thank you to everyone who spent an incredible time on this. To the Superintendent and her team who have been working day and night a huge thanks. This is impossible for families - there is no plan that works for working families - I've lost countless hours of sleep - but we have to pick a plan anyway - there is a long road ahead for public education in general. I make a motion to move forward with the Hybrid + Remote Plan, seconded by Member Ruseau. Here is my complete motion:**

**I make a motion that Medford Public Schools move forward with the Staggered Hybrid + Remote Plan. This plan allows families to select between hybrid and remote. We will ask all**

parents to choose between the MPS Remote Learning Academy and the Staggered Hybrid Learning plan. This decision will take effect on the first day of school.

For families who choose the MPS Remote Learning Academy for their child the following guidelines apply:

- While in the Remote Learning Academy, students will not necessarily be assigned to a teacher in their own building. All assignments will be based on demand, individuals needs, and equity considerations. Specific assignments will not be known until all family selections are registered through the parent survey, but Medford teachers will staff the Remote Learning Academy.
- The remote learning start time for all grade levels is TBD and will be determined at our August 17th School Committee meeting.
- Families may request to switch to hybrid effective January 4th. All decisions to swap must be made to MPS by December 1st on a form that will be developed. IEP/504/EL program considerations that require a model change will supersede this operational rule.

For families who request the Staggered - Hybrid option for their child, the following guidelines will apply:

- The hybrid model will follow the schedule outlined on pages 20-21 of the presentation.
- The hybrid schedule will be approved by the School Committee at the August 17th meeting.
- Families may request to move to the full remote option after the first marking period. A form will be developed to submit all requests
  - Family change requests, at the elementary level, are due by Friday, December 11th. The change will be effective Monday, January 4th. IEP/504/EL program considerations that require a model change will supersede this operational rule.
  - Family change requests, at the secondary level, are due by November 2nd. The change will be effective Monday, November 16th. IEP/504/EL program considerations that require a model change will supersede this operational rule.
- The Medford Health Department will provide a recommendation to the School Committee that complies with DESE guidance on health measures and accounts for local considerations. The recommendation will clearly outline which metrics will be used when what levels will allow us to proceed to the next phase or remain in the current phase. This framework will be provided to the School Committee for approval by September 15th.
- The School Committee will be convened in an emergency meeting should there be a need for a rapid response that diverges from this plan such as going to a full remote outside of

the dates above. Open Meeting Law allows for emergency meetings that do not meet the normal posting rules.

**Member McLaughlin - I make a motion to table this motion, until we get a chance to speak, seconded by Member Kreatz**

**Roll Call Vote**

**Mayor - 4-3 - Motion passes**

**Member McLaughlin - no easy decision - I want to make clear the names of the plans:**

**Hybrid plan or Plan 1 - several cohorts**

**Phased in Plan or Plan 2**

**Remote Plan or Plan 3**

**Remote is always on the table**

**Phased In Plan - no feedback or community engagement - should have had roundtables on this!**

**Member Mustone -we have received all different emails - all expressing worthy concerns, SEL, safety and education - staggered hybrid and remote option - some families need full in school option due to work concerns for families - In Everett - they are offering a remote learning in, supervised classroom, with breakfast and lunch - I would like to make a motion to discuss further or add this an option to part of the staggered or remote option - Everett's version is an education virtual learning center, staffed with school staff, opened to students with 6 ft distancing, with staggered times if needed - we have families struggling with full time work, who cannot work from home and may need this**

**Member McLaughlin - I make a motion to further discuss this learning opportunity**

**Mayor - Can we add this as an amendment to Graham motion?**

**Member Mustone - I don't want to hold up the plan, but I do feel we have to provide an option for those who need their child to be in school**

**Member Kreatz - Thank you to everyone for all of the hard work and the time put into this plan - a lot of difficulty this week to decide what to do with so many moving parts - Asked Rep Donato if State would provide daycare for those parents who can't work from home - or use the Y/Recreation space - there isn't a good choice here - I like that families will have a choice - what about the students on the bus - a lot of concerns in making this decision**

**Member Van der Kloot - this is an impossible decision - as we are all in an impossible place in our world - of course we are concerned about the safety and well being of our students and our teachers - I do worry about our kids, who might be left home by a desperate parent who has to go to work - we are making an extraordinary hard decision - remote is there for the offering -maybe bring in Grade 2 and Grade 12 sooner? But my understanding is that we need to vote on a plan tonight to send off to DESE - Can staggered plan be tweaked?**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes it can be tweaked. We submit our plan to DESE and they report back to us**

**Member Van der Kloot - how do we get the students to the Everett style plan?**

**Member Mustone - I'm not sure about Everett's transportation plan, but I believe we need to provide parents with every option possible, including a learning center for parents who can't work from home - we have to try to service our families to get the best education they need**

**Member McLaughlin - I would like to open it up to the community for their thoughts - can we please clarify the plans available: Hybrid, Phased In and**

**Remote?**

**Member Van der Kloot - the Phased In Plan is a phased in hybrid plan**

**Member Graham - I am not in favor of potentially moving around Grade 2 and Grade 12 - we have to make a decision - it is hard for families overall - I'm not in favor of leaving any wiggle room here - I do have a motion on the table -**

**Member Ruseau - the learning centers from Everett - I don't have any problem with added choices - but there isn't enough staff/space that will solve everyone's problems - I worry offering all the options we can and can we make it all work? There isn't enough money or staff to make this all work favorably for each family - too complicated to keep tacking on additional features - I seconded motion to take off the table**

**Member Kreatz - I like Member Mustone's suggestion - how would we add it to a plan?**

**Member Mustone - we should have it in the plan - I don't agree that I'm trying to go to everyone's door to see what they want - but there are people who need their child in the building 5 days a week**

**Member McLaughlin - move the motion so we can hear from the community**

**Member Ruseau - flushing that out... could take additional time - It's an option to explore, but to add it to the plan. It's about childcare not about education**

**Member Mustone - I think we need to try to make this happen - we need the board of health to approve the set up of course, but we need something for these parents.**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I propose a compromise - we are working on our parent survey - we could ask parents, do you have a specific need for coverage for your child? And see what numbers we might be dealing with**

**Member Mustone - That's a great idea and I support that**

**Member McLaughlin - How is the survey actually going to be incorporated into our plan?**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - After tonight's vote, based on that information, we'll go back to the plan and finalize the plan for DESE - DESE will review our options - then we add that decision to the survey - parents will have about 2 weeks to complete the survey. It will be translated. We will provide paper copies for those not online. We intend to reach 100% of our families**

**Member McLaughlin - Will the school committee have input into the survey?**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes**

**Mayor - Should we take off the table Member Graham's motion, seconded by Member Ruseau?**

**Roll Call Vote**

**Motion passes - 6-1 to take it off the table.**

**Member Van der Kloot - staggered plan - will start times be looked at?**

**Ms. Galusi - yes - once the plan is voted on, we will figure out the details**

**Member Graham - I'm not interested in taking out or in stripping details out of my motion - to potentially leave uncertainty for parents**

**Member McLaughlin - a division of the question to make separate motion on this motion?**

**Mayor - We won't divide it into 20 motions**

**Member Van der Kloot - I would like to ask the Superintendent a question - was the idea that all students in Remote Academy be divided into grade levels and not necessarily with teachers from their school?**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - since we don't know how many would choose this as their choice - so say only 12 at Roberts, then 4 at Columbus = a class. So until I know numbers, I'm unsure if we'd have 2 strands or 1 strand, we just don't know yet**

**Member Van der Kloot - To change from remote to hybrid on Jan 4th...? Is it feasible?**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - those are operational decisions - once a decision is made, but we have to make sure we don't run into a capacity issue**

**Member Van der Kloot - so any changes before Jan 4th, would be made on a case by case basis?**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - we'd need a lead time of about a month so we can address it**

**Member Van der Kloot - I'm looking for some flexibility -**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - once you are in a model, and in the middle of a term, to switch from one person to another person, it could be problematic - from an operational prospective get through 1 term,**

**Member Van der Kloot - It bothers me that it wasn't included in the original plan**

**Member McLaughlin - It's a lot to digest - a lot for our families to digest - I'm getting the feeling that have you been working on this with Member Graham prior to this?**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I was able to see the motion late yesterday from Member Graham - but this is Member Graham's motion, with the proposed dates from the information Member Graham received yesterday**

**Member McLaughlin - is it addressing the equity issue - another reason I'd divide the question...? Also was it against the law to see motion? Or against the law to discuss?**

**Mayor - could have been put on agenda or blind copied to us. If data is showing 3% or less, then maybe go hybrid, if it is 5% or higher, we'd go fully remote, but DESE does need the information by Monday, but either option is a good start**

**Member Ruseau - Am I correct, all districts must offer a full remote option?**

**Mayor - every family will have a choice to go remote, but as a district, what's our proposal?**

**Member Kreatz - we weren't able to share the Phased in plan with the community**

**Member Graham - We released a plan, we took comments, but people want to know how we plan to educate their children - families can't plan if we just select hybrid/remote plan - there will be hundreds of questions - We need to give more than what's required by DESE to our community**

**Member McLaughlin - how are IEP students being dealt with if they choose remote - looking at equity - and it's 10:09 PM and we haven't heard from any community members**

**Member Van der Kloot - staggered has a lot of good options - did another member receive it? Can you share the second part of the motion again?**

**Member Graham - I only shared it with Marice. The purpose is I would want Marice to say, this is what Hybrid means to us at the August 17th meeting**

**Member Van der Kloot - Can you please way in Dr. Edouard-Vincent?**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent- we can definitely have firmer schedules in place to present to you at the August 17th meeting**

**Member Van der Kloot - If this makes sense to everyone else, than so be it**

**Mr. Teixeira - One of the reasons we felt that every other week, was too long to be away from students - no more than 3 days being away from your teacher - that was the rationale**

**Member Van der Kloot - I understand, I was trying to clarify the August 17th change?**

**Member McLaughlin - I'm still looking for an answer through the chair, how are these considering our students with disabilities, especially the remote option?**

**Member Graham - my assumption was a change to an IEP would supercede this motion, I'll add in a line for the IEP per Member McLaughlin**

**Member McLaughlin - How does that assist our high need EL?**

**Mr. Teixeira - DESE will clarify on Monday**

**Mayor - there is a motion on the floor**

**Mclaughlin - I think there are 2 motions on the floor?**

**Member Van der Kloot - since we read down through the 2nd paragraph, can you read the next paragraph**

**Member McLaughlin - for the motion to split on the remote academy motion and the hybrid motion - for clarity and understanding**

**Mayor - Motion to divide by McLaughlin, seconded by Kreatz**

**Roll Call Vote**

**Motion to divide does not pass 4-3.**

**Mayor - On the main motion offered by Member Graham, seconded by**

**Member Ruseau - if metrics are showing right, I'd like to add Grade 2 onto the Hybrid Plan**

**Mayor - The motion is that the Medford Public Schools move forward with Hybrid + Remote Plan**

**Member McLaughlin - make a motion to clarify - Hybrid staggered plan**

**Member Van der Kloot - take the amendment first, motion by member Van der Kloot, seconded by Member Kreatz**

**Roll Call Vote**

**Motion passes- 7-0**

**Mayor - on the main motion by Member Graham, seconded by Member Ruseau**

**Roll Call Vote**

**Motion passes 6-1**

**Member Mustone's amendment, seconded by Member Kreatz to add the survey question for parental needs for virtual learning center if one was to be developed**

**Roll Call Vote**

**Motion passes - 7-0**

**Member McLaughlin - for our seniors, delaying them until November isn't fair. Can they start on September 15th, as long as the ventilation issue is able to be addressed?**

**Member Van der Kloot - If we are putting off students due to HVAC concerns at MHS, could we utilize the science labs?**

**Dr. Cushing - that is 300 students and the vocational students that we have already planned to bring into the building.**

**Mayor -I think we need to fix the classroom/ventilation system first - it has to depend on that.**

**Roll Call Vote**

**Motion passes 5-2**

**Member McLaughlin - I make a motion for community participation**

**Mayor - We will be hosting additional listening sessions - it's 10:30 PM and I'm unsure if this is still a public meeting...?**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I'm open to another roundtable or something else next week**

**Member McLaughlin - I'm keeping my motion on the table**

**Member Ruseau - I agree with motion. I second it. But what is the time limit?**

**Mayor - 1 minute and a ½**

**Roll Call**

**Motion passes 7-0**

**Member McLaughlin - Mayor please clarify procedure to speak**

**Mayor - Please use the raised hand feature for community participation**

**Grace Bwala - What about before & after school programs?**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We want to offer before and after school programs, but with 6 ft guidelines, we are looking into that.**

**Ashley F - I don't appreciate that new plan had no community input**

**Leticia Rocha - high school student - no transportation, no lunch plans - are every student being tested? We don't know the long term effects. We do**

**know this is a deadly virus. It could be devastating to our students and community.**

**Beth Fasciterlli - I would like to thank everyone who worked on these plans - we are in a global pandemic -I do feel however, that it seems inappropriate for a school committee member to add an amendment due to her son who is entering his senior year - the priority should be to keep people healthy and safe**

**Member McLaughlin - I disclosed that my son is a senior but he's one of the 300 seniors - it's for all of the seniors**

**Jean Zotter - Thank you for everyone's hard work - Can teachers/staff opt out if at high risk? Remote metrics? What metrics does BOH use? Can my son still take honors classes via remote?**

**Dr. Cushing - our goal is to offer honors classes. And I'll follow up with an email tomorrow regarding the staff and metric questions.**

**Ms. Durham - I didn't like that the plan was changed today, without reading it, I did read the powerpoint document this weekend. Will siblings be allowed to follow the same schedule as my IEP child? Also, were successes and failures graded over the spring? I had to leave my nursing job, because my daughter's needs weren't being met.**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent -We'd have to see where our numbers fall - difficult to answer right now. With the new model - much clearer and consistent than in the Spring - fully remote won't look like it did last spring**

**Andrea Polcaro - thank you for all of your hard work - what about those who might not have completed an IEP?**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - our director of Pupil services will assist you.**

**Ms. Bowen - for students in process for an IEP, we will be reaching out to parents, for one-on-one testing and determine what services a student may need**

**Kristina Gasson - Thank you for all of your hard work. I'm concerned about the hybrid model with staggered starts. Unclear about rationales for some of these plans - picking and choosing grades, with metrics all over the place - more prudent to go all remote until we really know what's going on**

**Jane Hamel - I'm concerned that we don't have the resources to handle all of these options. I think this is a massive undertaking. I think we are over committing**

**Lisa Schwartz - Thank you all, it is an impossible task - How will grading be handled?**

**Ms. Galusi - DESE wants grading - no longer Pass/Fail**

**Vanessa Farzner - Thank you for all the hard work, as it is an impossible task - nice to hear about a hybrid - I hope the communication with teachers union doesn't change anything - but I don't agree about selecting certain grades**

**Ingrid Mocada - I agree with Jane, as I think we are trying to do too much - very hard to choose, without all the details - I don't think we have the capacity if everyone wanted to select the hybrid model. Will the plan be translated? How can you get 100% participation for the survey? What happens if covid is diagnosed in a classroom?**

**Mayor - We do have capacity to do the hybrid with the 6ft rule - just will have to stagger it**

**Dr. Cushing - We will translate the final document in the 4 languages, this is a draft. We did receive over 100 pages of questions prior so our intention to publish them and we are working on them**

**Mr. Milaschewski - It is our goal to reach all of our families, so we need to be very creative/thoughtful to reach all of our families - We are thinking about the possibility of offering a drive up with translations, or drop offs for ESY, any input is appreciated, we are committed to 100% as possible. Please feel free to email me with any suggestions.**

**Member Graham - Contract tracing in plan is vague to me - maybe that part can be clarified?**

**Mayor - We will have that part relooked at by Ms. Wray and our Board of Health.**

**Ms. Day - This is an unprecedented time and no one wants to be here right now - I am a single mom/covid nurse - 100% virtual seems unfeasible to me - phasing youngest students in first, could really reduce outbreak**

**Gabby - Fine Arts are important**

**Mayor - DESE isn't allowing us to do music in the building, but we will offer art and physical education**

**Gabby - The Vocational School will be able to go into high school first?**

**Dr. Cushing - There is significant work to do on the MHS building, so we need to limit access and add as much ventilation as possible - Fine Arts is still a priority**

**Reanna Panico - Will the survey be per family or per student? Are the schedules samples?**

**Mayor - 1 survey per student / schedules were just samples**

**Jen Lewis - Petition questions, weren't answered, (change.org) - When will you tell teachers what they are teaching, so they can plan their curriculum asap? - The drive up option for family feedback doesn't take into account those families without vehicles. - Maybe have a walk up to city hall as an option. - Why wasn't the phased start plan announced prior to the start of this meeting?**

**Mayor - DESE will provide guidance if someone were to test positive - listening to the comments coming in, the teacher's union, and taking all that in, we came to the phased in plan proposal**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I echo the Mayor's comments - if it was up to me, I'd do all hybrid, we are doing damage not allowing students to interact in person. We shifted the all hybrid, due to ventilation concerns.**

**Member McLaughlin - We have done a lot of work, but communication is still a bit problematic - The petition should have been answered. We are not meeting that goal or our goal for equity either.**

**Mayor - I think it would be unfair to respond to one petition, but the school team is working extremely hard**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - I would beg to differ, we have over 100 pages of questions that have come to us via the email [info@medford.k12.ma.us](mailto:info@medford.k12.ma.us) - we need to be equitable and fair, we gave one modality, and to submit under another modality, isn't fair.**

**Dr. Cushing - We will, however, add those questions into our main question and answer document.**

**Kate Willard - My understanding was that we wouldn't move to in person learning, as the ventilation at the newer schools aren't perfect either - I'm extremely anxious to go to in person learning - not sure you are considering teacher needs, we need that support.**

**Ellyn LaVecchia - Could anyone speak to the union negotiations as don't they ultimately determine the rules for us?**

**Mayor - That's correct. We will have to impact bargain**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Impact bargaining is ongoing, so I'm not able to speak to all the things that are being discussed**

**J - What if someone had an unexpected problem arise could they change the model, due to an emergency situation for example?**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We will work with families as much as possible. We will try to provide services on a school based level, but we have to be mindful of capacity levels**

**Mayor - But we would work with the family to assist**

**Theresa Castignaetti - Please do not put families or staff at risk - remote is best.**

**Tracy Nash - I am new to the district. How do you assess the curriculum that is being taught remotely? Can students still take honors courses?**

**Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We follow the standard curriculum that is provided by the State of Massachusetts.**

**Bond Family - The distant learning seems very rigid, can it be a little more flexible?**

**Ms. Galusi - These are sample schedules that eventually will be fine tuned. Live and recorded lessons would be available - younger levels wanted a more structured schedule.**

**Alison Leed -My kindergarten student needs socialization - virtual was hard for pre K lessons - maybe alternate Wednesdays they could go into school?**

**Claire Flaherty -I have a second grader, with a 504 plan - not sure how this will work with remote option if he doesn't know his teacher**

**Ms. Galusi - we do plan to create opportunities for students to meet their peers and their teachers, so that they can all meet one another, before learning virtually, We hope this will help. Hybrid won't look the same, desks were grouped, but we will have to reorganize. Room may look different, but education will be the same**

**Member McLaughlin - I make a motion that all of the task force subcommittee notes be shared on the task force section of the website, seconded by Member Graham.**

**Roll Call - 7-0 - motion passes**

**Motion to adjourn by Member Kreatz, seconded by Member Ruseau**

**Roll Call Vote 7-0**

**Meeting is adjourned at 12:12 AM**

